BLOOM PROJECT

2027 COHORT · CALL FOR CIVIC HOSTS

The Public Assembly on AI

AI issues decided locally. Connected across the country.

Applications due November 20, 2026

THE MOMENT

The choices AI raises are already on the table.

WHERE WE LIVE

Should our county approve a data center, and on what terms?

HOW WE LEARN AND WORK

What rules should govern AI in our schools and workplaces?

WHO BENEFITS

Who should share in the gains from AI, and who bears the risks?

Polls capture what people think in isolation. Social media rewards what divides us.

Communities need a way to work through these choices together, and to build the civic power to see them through.

The invitation

Over the past year, the BLOOM Project has developed a community assembly model with local partners that combines digital tools with deliberative public problem-solving. Now we're inviting a cohort of Civic Hosts to help build the Public Assembly on AI: a network of communities across the United States working out what they want from AI.



~1,000
people engaged in our 2026 pilots

6
counties, in Utah and Central Oregon

75
delegates across civic assemblies in Utah and Central Oregon

COMPLETED **Utah Solutions Forum · Draper, September 18–19, 2026**

38 delegates selected by civic lottery took up the public's role in AI decisions and produced 10 policy recommendations, each with at least 82% agreement.

How the Public Assembly on AI works

The Public Assembly gives communities the tools, organizing support, and connections to act at every level.

1 **Local**
Hosts bring their communities together to find common ground and act where they can.

›

2 **State**
Shared priorities across communities set the agenda for state-level representative assemblies.

›

3 **National**
Questions that need further action shape a national civic assembly on AI, bringing local perspectives to the national stage.

PRINCIPLES

Locally hosted

Trusted local organizations convene their own communities, coached by a civic hub or by BLOOM.

Reasoning together

Community forums and open polls map agreement, division, and common ground, building relationships that make change last.

Built for action

Every assembly maps decision-makers, acts where it can, and delivers what the community concludes in public.

Power that adds up

Each host builds a constituency behind its common ground. When communities reach shared conclusions, they can speak with the weight of many places.

Are you a Civic Host?

Civic Hosts

Civic Hosts are local organizations or community leaders rooted in a town, county, or constituency, with the relationships to bring their community together across divides.

Ideal hosts work where something clear is at stake: a decision about AI that a nameable body will make on a nameable timeline, or a plan to put a missing decision on the table.

Organizations and coalitions of any size are welcome, including congregations, civic clubs, and informal networks. Individual community leaders can apply through a partner organization or fiscal sponsor.

Potential topics

Hosts choose the issues most relevant to their community.

- **Data centers & AI infrastructure**
- **Jobs and workforce**
- **AI in K–12 and higher education**
- **Surveillance and privacy**
- **Risks of powerful AI**
- **Power & wealth concentration**

State and regional civic hubs

Already supporting a network of local civic organizations? Inquire about joining as a civic hub: hello@bloom-project.org.

What hosts receive

FUNDING FROM BLOOM

Short arc

$10,000–$30,000

Long arc

$50,000–$60,000

per site from the BLOOM Project

Amounts are set by the scale of your community, the number of co-hosts, and travel. Grants support staff time, venue and food, and local outreach.

Methods	A playbook built from our pilots in Utah and Oregon, refined with and for this cohort.
Platform	CivicOS tools for live conversations, open polls, and public reports.
Training	Facilitation and organizing, plus coaching, through your civic hub or BLOOM.
A peer cohort	A national network of hosts on the same timeline, plus a state or regional cluster where there's a civic hub.

We'll match each host to the arc that fits its community, its capacity, and what's at stake.

How we will assess

1 Existing relationships and convening capacity

Good standing with enough different people to convene partners: faith, labor, youth and education, small business, neighborhood and civic, or whoever the real constituencies are where you are.

2 A commitment to collaborative politics

Committed to finding out what people think through deliberation, rather than confirming what you already believe.

3 Organizing or policy capacity

Hosts who know local decision-makers and can turn people out through their networks will likely be more successful. BLOOM helps with synthesis, reporting, and pathways to impact.

4 A learning partner

This is a first cohort. We're looking for hosts who will try things, tell us plainly what isn't working, and help shape the model for the communities that come next.

TWO KINDS OF COMMUNITY ASSEMBLY

Short arc

Works towards a map of community priorities: what's immediately actionable, and what needs further deliberation. 10–12 weeks, about 120 hours, led by one to two people.

FUNDING FROM BLOOM

$10,000–$30,000

One-to-ones

Conversations that bring local leaders into the inquiry on a pressing AI issue.

Community forums

30–50 residents meet to sort out local priorities, name local actions, and flag what needs state action.

Open poll

Engage hundreds of residents to create a map of the opinion landscape, including common ground.

Results

A map of community priorities that are immediately actionable and what needs further deliberation.

TWO KINDS OF COMMUNITY ASSEMBLY

Long arc

Works towards community recommendations, tested for broad agreement and put to a public ratification vote. 6 month commitment

FUNDING FROM BLOOM

$50,000–$60,000

Agenda setting

The short arc.

Goal setting

Community forum and open poll rounds surface shared values, ending in a goals statement the community stands behind.

Idea development

Additional community forum and open poll rounds develop potential solutions.

Tradeoffs

Residents weigh options together, producing a map of tradeoffs to carry into decision making.

Decision making

Recommendations are drafted, tested for broad agreement, and put to a public ratification vote.

CivicOS: BLOOM's open-source deliberation platform

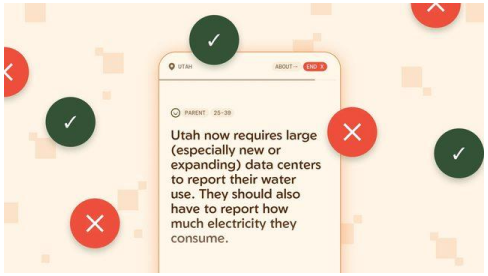
Every Civic Host gets lifetime access to CivicOS and training on how to use it.



Table Themer

Captures what each table says during community forums and civic assemblies, and shows the themes emerging across the room as the conversation happens.

Used in community and civic assemblies



Open Poll

Residents add their own statements and react to their neighbors' (agree, disagree, or unsure), mapping where the community agrees, where it divides, and what common ground already exists.

Try the national Open Poll



Public reports

Turns everything people said into a clear public report that decision-makers and neighbors can read in minutes.

See the Central Oregon report

Impact

1

Government policy

Every host identifies decision-makers and decisions on a timeline: a county commission vote, a district's classroom policy, an employer's deployment plan, a state bill. What the community concludes is delivered to those decision-makers in public.

2

Community action

Much of what a community decides it wants needs no official's permission: workplace monitoring policies, a parent council adopting school guidance, a library running AI literacy sessions.

3

Agency & connection

Participants leave with the experience of making a difference in their community, practice in deliberation and facilitation, and relationships with neighbors they would not otherwise have met.

Timeline

Oct 15, 2026
Applications open

Nov 20, 2026
Applications close

Dec 2026
Interviews

Jan 15, 2027
Hosts notified

Feb–Jul 2027
Community assemblies

First half 2028
National assembly on AI

Selection Process

The application takes about an hour. Short-listed finalists are invited to interviews in December. Being invited is not a guarantee of selection.

The arc

Short arc assemblies run 10–12 week arcs between February and July 2027, with staggered starts; long arc assemblies run across the full window. Together, this network can commission state or national assemblies on AI in 2028.

About BLOOM

We help people go beyond divisions to breakthrough common ground solutions where the sum is greater than the parts.



Rahmin Sarabi

Co-Founder and Co-ED
Leads programs and CivicOS.



Clara Long

Co-Founder and Co-ED
Leads fundraising, communications, and ecosystem.



Zabrae Valentine

Deliberation Design & Policy Impact; prev New Hampshire Together, Engaged California.



Humphrey Obuobi

Design & Programs from host recruitment to facilitation methods and products to support it all.



Mike Grafton

Engineering for CivicOS, with our partner Crown Shy.



Wren Elhai

Strategy & Partnerships from host development to pathways for impact.



Audrey Tang

Founding Senior Advisor. Taiwan's former Minister of Digital Affairs.

APPLICATIONS OPEN OCTOBER 15, 2026

Build your community's civic power and agency over the AI decisions ahead.

Apply by November 20, 2026

Have questions before you apply?
Info session Thursday, October 22, 10:00 AM PT / 1:00 PM ET.
hello@bloom-project.org